Darb 1718 Overview

About

Darb 1718

Currently situated in the heart of Old Cairo, **Darb 1718** is a contemporary art and culture center that has continuously breathed life into the Egyptian contemporary arts scene. Since it's founding in **2008,** Darb 1718's mission on the one hand, is to **inspire, build confidence** and **support the development of emerging artists in Egypt,** and on the other hand, to expose the public at large to **international arts and cultural movements.** Darb 1718 aims to override cultural, social, and economical differences through arts and culture.

We support contemporary arts in Egypt by providing a full-fledged arts and culture facility for artists and the public in Egypt. This is enacted through our efforts to:

- Provide suitable spaces and resources for **exhibitions, concerts, festivals, independent film screenings** and **arts workshops.**
- Ensure the **accessibility of the arts** through offering spaces for participatory **alternative arts education**, especially for underrepresented societal groups.
- Continuously engage **local artisans** in the Egyptian contemporary arts movement.
- Promote **community engagement** through the arts.
- Provide **guidance and training** to promote creativity and artistic expression **in Egypt and abroad.**
- Promote underground **music** and innovative art forms.
- Provide **international artists** with the space and resources to experience the Egyptian local art scene as well as **cross-cultural co-creation in our artist residency programs.**

EXHIBITIONS & ARTIST RESIDENCIES

CONCERTS & FILM SCREENINGS

COMMUNITY OUTREACH

WORKSHOPS & LOCAL ARTISANS

EXHIBITIONS

UNSPOKEN ما لم يقال

September 12 - September 25, 2026

Darb1718

Through Art, Through Healing
An experimental exhibition exploring art as a tool for healing, self-expression, and rehabilitation, featuring artworks created by people recovering from addiction and mental health conditions through art therapy sessions at Gamal Abu Al Azayem Hospital, a rehabilitation institution supporting people through their recovery journeys.

درب في الحديقة

Darb fi Al-Hadiqqa

A Path in the Garden

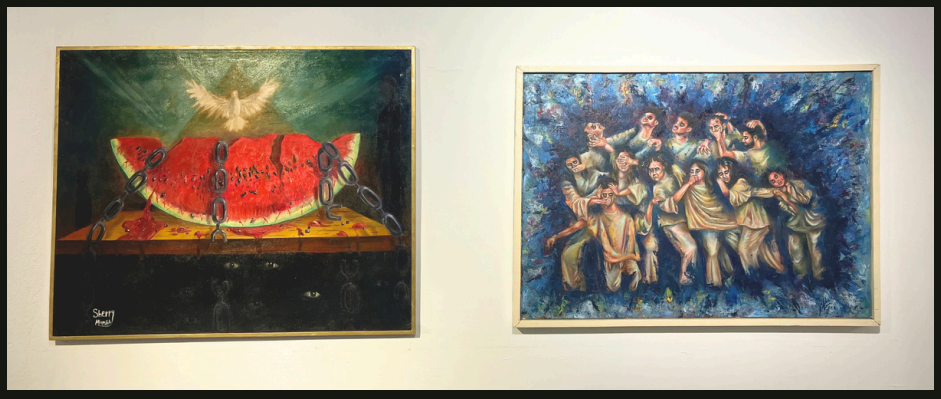
November 25 – December 14, 2025
Darb 1718
catalog here.
Featured in **CairoScene,** this large-scale mixed media group exhibition presented works by 17 artists and was accompanied by two public workshops.

INBETWEEN: Thin Places, Movements, and Meetings
May 22 - June 4, 2025
Darb 1718, Old Cairo
Catalog here.

مش مجرد عيال

Observer Speaks: A Young Artists' Guide to the World

august 16-23, 2025
darb 1718
catalog here.



Filmscreening

Jusoor" is a series of short film screenings with the aim to support the work of young filmmakers, create a platform for them at Darb 1718, and build bridges across different cultures in Cairo while celebrating diversity. After each screening, we invite the directors and cast to join an open discussion with the audience.

Sudanese Night

The series began with a special screening of four short films by Sudanese filmmakers: Dukhan (Sudanese Smoke) by Mohamed Subahi, Braids of Identity by Hafsa Baraei, The Last Henna by Mohannad Bilal, and Motive by Alargam Muzmail.

Collaboration with Left Bank Cinema Collective

featuring experimental and documentary short films by Iranian filmmakers. The screening brought together cinema, artistic experimentation, and cultural exchange

Natalia Ossef

Residency

During her residency at Darb 1718, Natalia Ossef explored textile and craft traditions in Egypt as part of her artistic research and practice. Her time in Cairo included visits to the Ramses Wissa Wassef Art Center, khayameya courses in Bab Zuweila, and a visit to Tunis Village in Fayoum, allowing her to engage with different local craft practices and traditions.

The residency concluded with an open studio at Darb 1718, where Natalia shared her artistic practice, research, and reflections on her experience of learning and working in Cairo throughout the residency.

Tales of Fustat: Cyanotype Workshop

حكاوي الفسطاط

Held at Darb 1718, this two-session workshop combines documentary photography and alternative printing. Participants start with a guided photowalk through the Fustat pottery village, meeting local artists and craftsmen, conducting brief interviews, and creating portrait photographs reflecting the area's social and cultural life.

In the second session, they learn the fundamentals of cyanotype printing and transform their selected images into handmade prints assembled in personal notebooks, accompanied by written stories.

A Room of One's Own
غرفة تخصّنا وحدنا

A four-week writing series facilitated by feminist writer and anthropology researcher Aisha Aljaedy.

Throughout the sessions, participants explored ideas of home, private space, gender, boundaries, and the different versions of ourselves that emerge in spaces shared with others — through reading, conversation, and writing.

VOICE IN MOTION

الحَرَكَةُ فِي الصّوْتِ

Exploring the voice as a tool for play, expression, and connection through simple group exercises, movement, listening, and improvisation

Alexandria Biennale

Egypt’s iconic Alexandria Biennale is back after a 12-year break, curated by Moataz Nasr under the theme “This Too Shall Pass.” With artists from across the Mediterranean and the globe, the event aims to introduce fresh energy and spark meaningful cultural change.

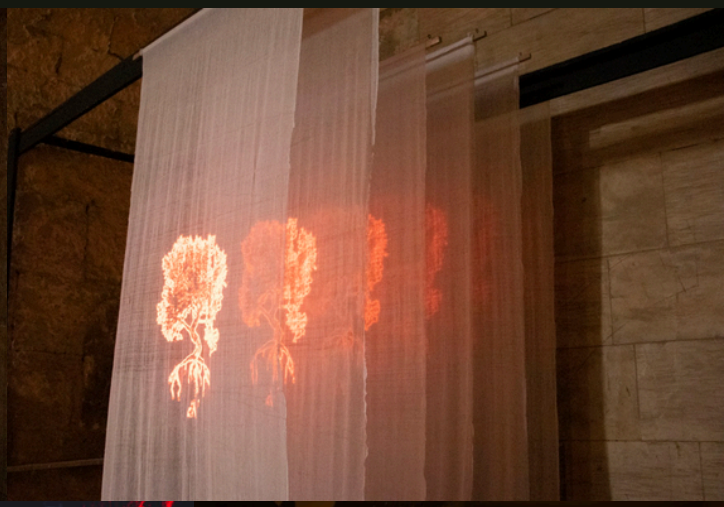
Something Else:
A Contemporary Art Event

Something Else is an international contemporary visual arts exhibition, which was initially designed to run parallel to the official Cairo Biennale. However, due to the recurrent cancellations of the state run biennale, Something Else is now organized independently by the arts and culture organization Darb 1718. Something Else aims to explore the meaning of contemporary art today, introduce new and progressive presentations to the Egyptian art scene, further connect Egypt to the international art scene, and offer an opportunity for exchange among artists, curators, and local artisans.

Darb 1718 has successfully hosted five previous versions of Something Else: 2015, 2018, 2023 at the Cairo Citadel, the 2025 Symposium hosted at Bayt Al Sinnari and Darb 1718, and the 2026 edition at Bayt Al Sinnari.

Something Else Symposium
February 8-22, 2025
Darb 1718 and Bayt Al Sinnary, Old Cairo
Catalog here.

Something Else at the Citadel - November 2023, Citadel of Salah Al Din



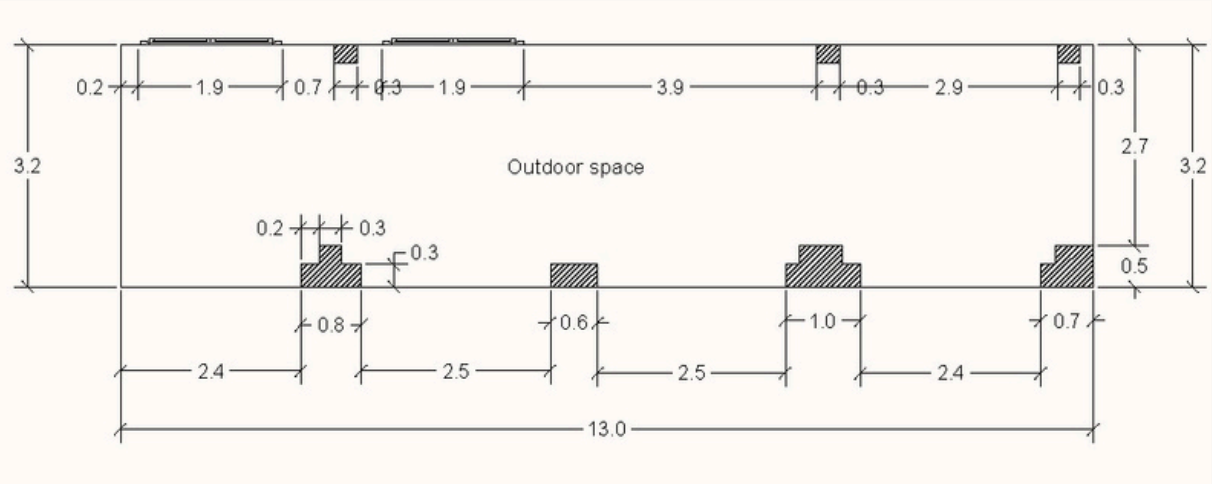
Something Else’s edition at the Citadel ran from November 23 - December 23, 2023. Featuring 22 curators and 171 artists, representing 42 different countries, this contemporary exhibition at the Cairo Citadel was the first of its kind in this setting. The exhibition theme was inspired by the poet W.B. Yeats, titled "What Then?"

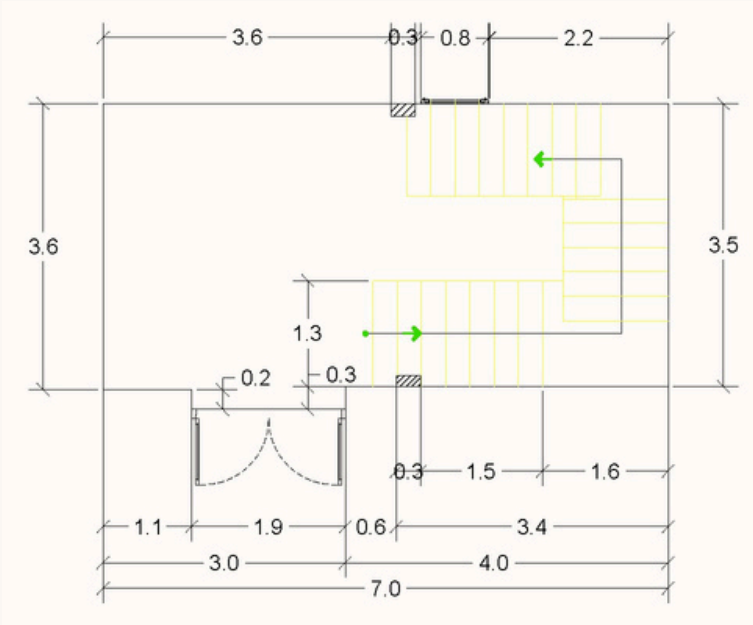
Yeats suggested that it was foolish to ever think that the work was done. The work is never done. On the contrary. It is a never-ending process of awareness and actions. There is always something else to be discovered, something else to be formulated, something else to be invented. Something Else III responded to the question posed by Yeats, "what then?" with "something else." Featuring the Chief Curator Simon Njami, Artistic Director Moataz Nasr, and guest of honor Ahmed Nawwar.

https://somethingelse.art/previous-editions/

Plans by Rokaya Abdelhafez

2D Plan Outdoor space





2D Plan First floor

2D Plan Second floor